

Is Cantonese *Dou1* Changing?

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WOC-25

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19/07/2025

Mandarin *Dou*

- *Dou* is generally interpreted as a universal quantifier in Mandarin, even without ‘indicators’ like *quanbu*, *mei* etc.

(1) 他們 都 吃 蘋果

Tamen dou chi pingguo

They DOU eat apples

‘They **all** eat apples.’

Cantonese *Dou1*

- Cantonese *dou1* also expresses UQ reading.
- Extra word (such as *cyun4bou6*, doubled Cl, *mui5+Cl* etc.) is often required when no context is given (Hsu & Lee, 2020).

(2) 佢地 全部 都 食 蘋果

Keoi5dei6 cyun6bou6 dou1 sik6 ping4gwo2

They all DOU eat apples

‘They **all** eat apples.’

Cantonese Dou1

- Without any context, bare *dou1* in Cantonese is generally interpreted as an adverbial meaning ‘also’ (Hsu & Lee, 2020).

(3) 佢地 都 食 蘋果

Keoi5dei6 dou1 sik6 ping4gwo2

They DOU eat apples

‘They **also** eat apples.’ (There is another group of people mentioned earlier who eat apples.)

Mandarin Dou and Cantonese Dou1

- This difference can be explained by the lack of *ye* 也 in Cantonese.
- *Ye* functions as 'also' in Mandarin while *dou1* functions as both 'also' and UQ in Cantonese.

Ye —————→ 'also'
Dou —————→ UQ

Dou1 —————→ 'also'
 |
 |————→ UQ

- Syntactically, indicators like *mui5go3* bears a $[i\forall: _]$ feature such that it requires agreement with a $[i\forall: +]$ *dou1* in order to be valued (Yip, 2021).
- This forces *dou1* to be interpreted as UQ for the sentence to be grammatical.

A trend observed in Cantonese

- However, in recent years, it is observed that bare *dou1* is used and interpreted as UQ more frequently than before.

(4) 我地 都 誤會 咗 美斯
Ngo5dei6 dou1 ng6wui6 zo2 mei5si1

We DOU misunderstand ASP Messi

‘We **all** misunderstood Messi.’

(LIHKG, 2024)

(5) 點解 你地 都 咁 中意 買 TSLA
Dim2gaai2 nei5dei6 dou1 gam3 zung1ji3 maai5 TSLA

Why you DOU so like buy Tesla

‘Why do you **all** like to buy Tesla stock so much?’

(LIHKG, 2024)

A trend observed in Cantonese

(5) 你地 都 係 一 班 唔 抵得

Nei5dei6 dou1 hai6 jat1 baan1 m4 dai2dak1

You DOU COP one Cl NEG resigned to

女仔 叻 過 你 嘅 KamL

Neoi5zai2 lek1 gwo3 nei5 ge3 kem5lan2

girls smarter than you GEN wierdos

‘You are **all** just a group of wierdos who are not resigned to the fact that some girls are smarter than you.’ (LIHKG, 2024)

- This can be explained by the increasing influence from Mandarin.

Methods

- A survey is conducted to investigate whether Cantonese speakers start to interpret *dou1* without any indicator (hereafter bare *dou1*) as a UQ.
- Assuming younger Cantonese speakers have more exposure to Mandarin at a younger age, it is predicted that more young Cantonese speakers will interpret bare *dou1* as UQ.

Methods - Questionnaire

學校有好多老師同學生，小賣部阿姨觀察咗今日唔同人買咗咩嘢食，個阿姨話：「老師都食咗 *
咖喱魚蛋」。

請問有幾多老師食咗咖喱魚蛋？

- ☐ 全部老師
- ☐ 唔肯定，但起碼一個老師

承上題，請問除咗老師之外，學生有冇食咖喱魚蛋？ *

- ☐ 有
- ☐ 條題目冇講

Methods - Questionnaire

榮俊同志明討論緊佢地睇過咩戲，志明話：「我有睇古天樂嘅戲」，而榮俊話：「古天樂嘅戲，我都睇過」。*

請問榮俊睇過幾多套古天樂嘅戲？

- ☐ 古天樂嘅所有戲
- ☐ 唔肯定，但至少一套

Results

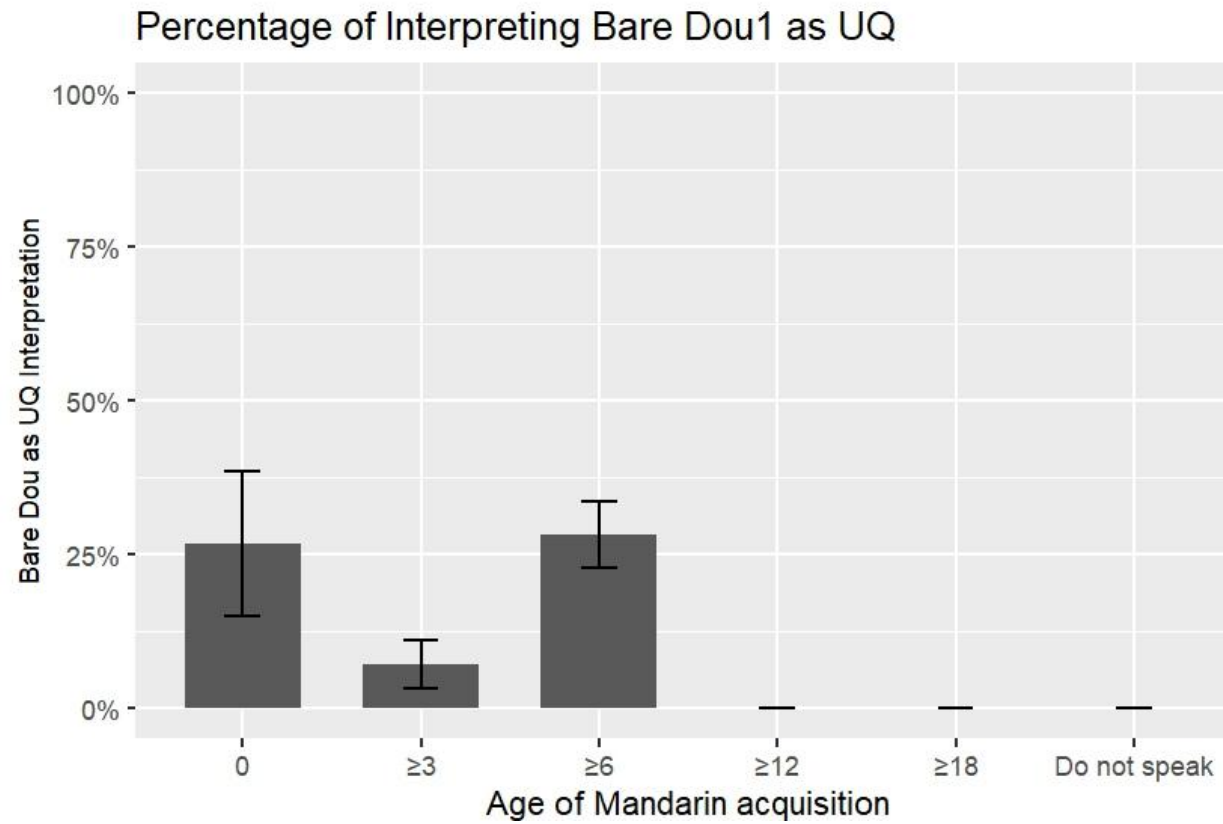
- 148 respondents completed the questionnaire.
- Their ages range from 12 to 71.
- 老師都食咗咖喱魚蛋。
- Only 3.38% interpreted bare *dou1* as UQ when a bare noun subject is quantified.
- 啲老師都食咗咖喱魚蛋。
- When a preceding collective quantifier *di1* is added before the subject, 19.6% have a UQ reading.

Results

- 古天樂嘅戲，我都睇過。
- 18.2% interpreted bare *dou1* as UQ when the (topicalized) object is quantified.
- 古天樂啲戲，我都睇過。
- When a preceding *di1* is added, 34.5% have a UQ reading.

Results

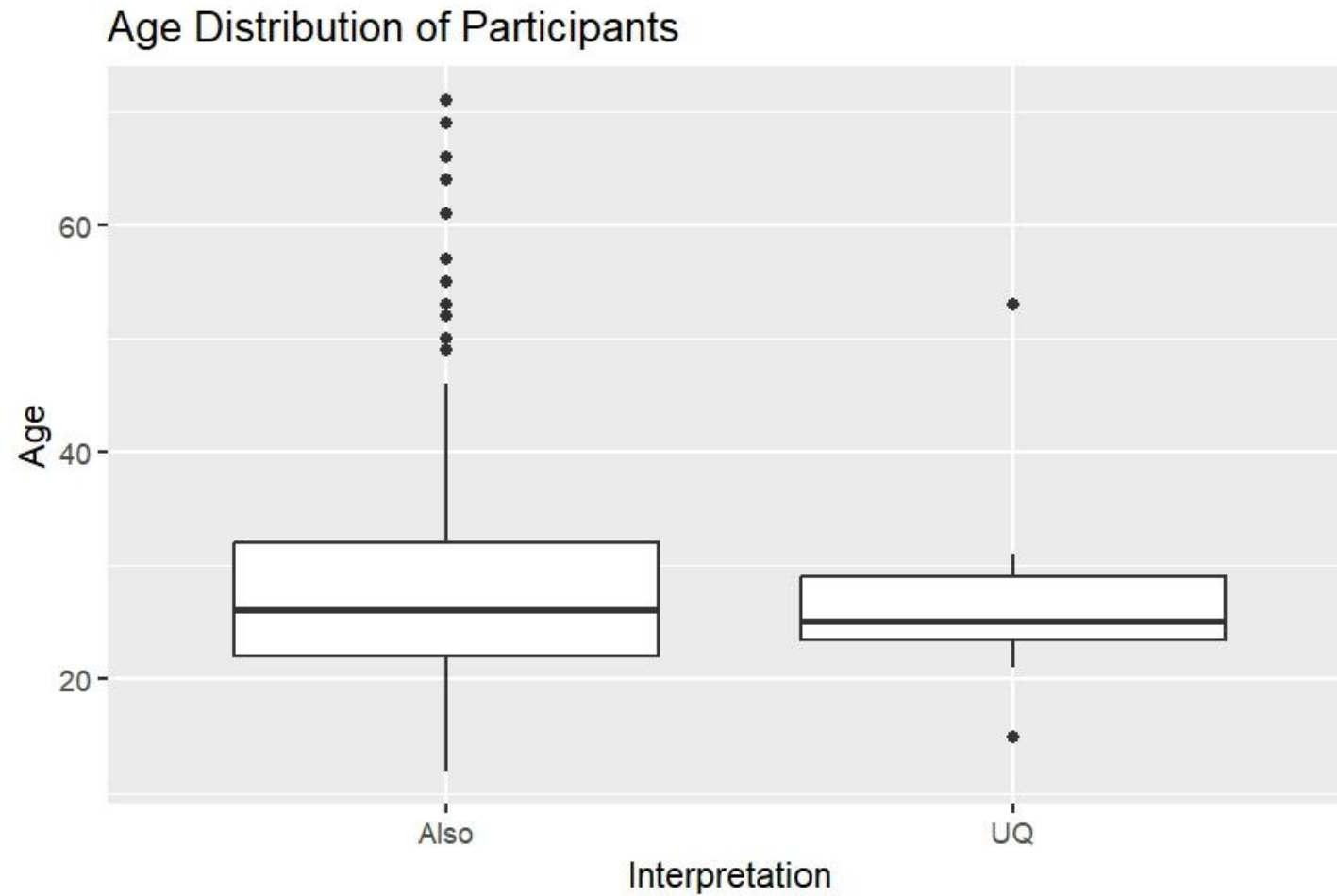
- All respondents who have a UQ reading of bare *dou1* are exposed to Mandarin before age 6.
- This supports our hypothesis that this effect is indeed a result of Mandarin influence.



Results

- However, the linear logistic regression model shows that:
- A significant effect of age is **not** found in the interpretation of bare *dou1* when subject is quantified ($\beta = -.003$, $SE = .23$, $z = -.01$, $p = .99$).
- A significant effect of age is **not** found in the interpretation of bare *dou1* when topicalized object is quantified ($\beta = -.005$, $SE = .01$, $z = -.34$, $p = .73$).
- In sum, no significant effect of age can be found in any of the constructions above.

Results



Discussions

- Although the results support that interpreting bare *dou1* as UQ is a result of early exposure to Mandarin, it is **not found** that younger Cantonese speakers tend to interpret bare *dou1* as UQ more.
- This could imply that:
- *Dou1* has not changed as expected in young Cantonese speakers
- Or, the results is biased due to flaws in the design of questionnaire, stimuli used, sampling of participants etc.
 - A considerable number of respondents reported that they could guess the purpose of the questionnaire.
- Or, Mandarin influence on the reading of *dou1* might be shown in other constructions

Dou1 in wh-questions



aa3zaak6 07/20/24

...

全稱量化嘅「都」同疑問詞共現，我嘅語感入面好多限制

- (1) 而家 ?啲/個個小朋友都用「大癲」
- (2) 而家 *啲/??個個小朋友都用啲咩潮語
- (3) 啲咩潮語而家 ?啲/個個小朋友都用

首先 (1) 用「啲」，冇咗「全部」「所有」或者量詞重疊，我會自動當咗「都」係「連…都」嘅限定都

跟住全稱都同疑問可以共現，但係疑問詞唔可以喺賓語位置(2)，但係主題化咗(3)就好得多

但係其實就算係普通話，(2) 入面「都」都會令後面嘅疑問詞被理解為 [-Q]，「某啲」嘅意思，而粵普嘅分別似乎係在於普通話可以用 prosody 去救返呢個情況，夾硬 force 個「都後疑問詞」去擺個疑問 reading 而粵語唔得。

不過試下粵語加「話waa2」助詞又好似救到：

- (4) 而家?啲/個個小朋友都講啲咩潮語話。

結論：全稱都後有疑問詞，粵語好差，普通話可以全靠 Prosody 修補；粵語同樣有加句末助詞修補機制；如果可以接受原文，噉你嘅疑問詞 prosody 可能有咗變化。

(睇落同 Victor Pan 個 account 都幾一致。Link 喺 comment)

(求其噏，唔好抄我) [Translate](#)

Dou1 in wh-questions

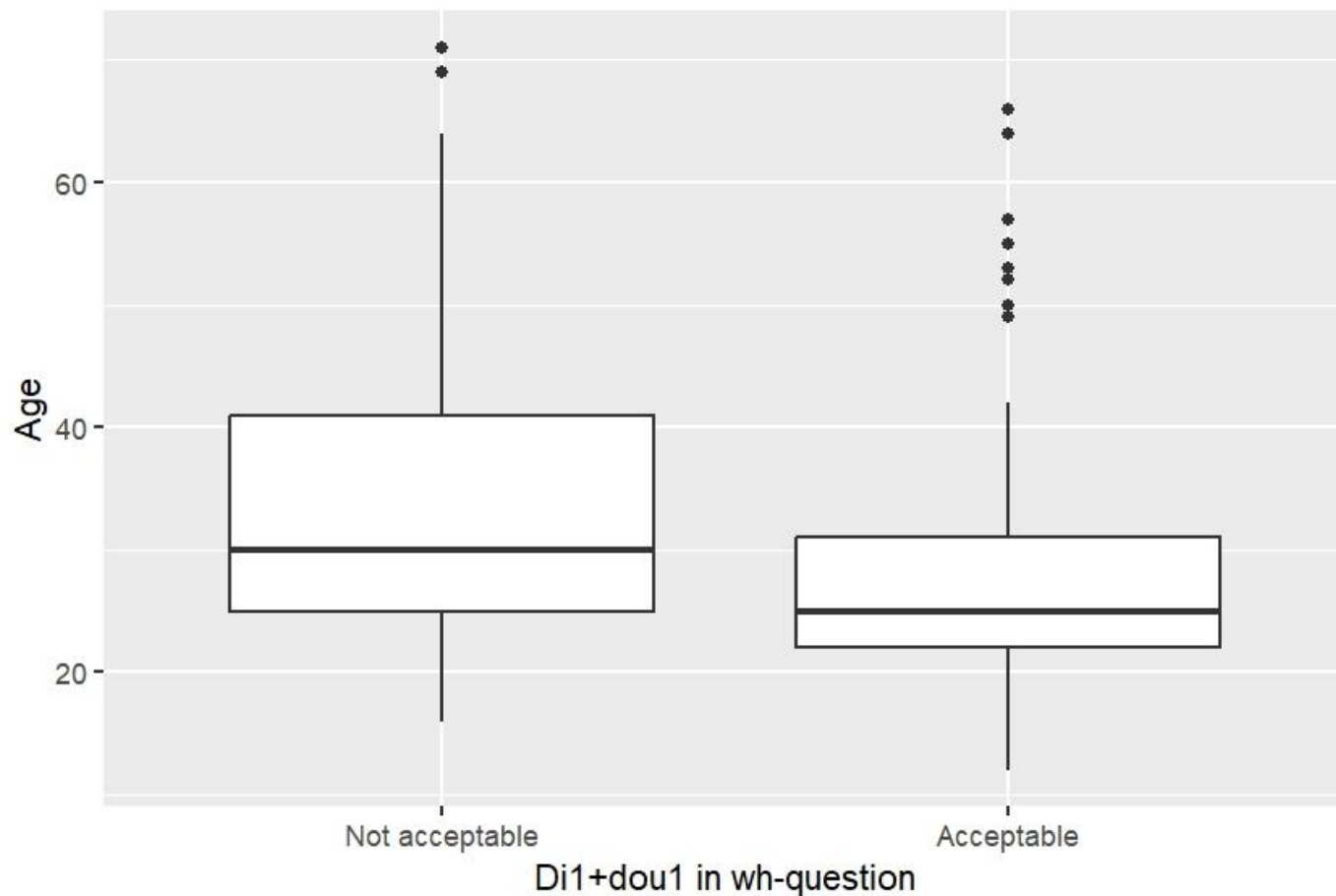
志明細個嘅時候，個個細路都睇龍珠，但佢唔知而家有邊套卡通片係每個細路都會睇，志明會問：

- ☐ 而家細路都睇咩卡通？
- ☐ 而家個個細路都睇咩卡通？
- ☐ 而家啲細路都睇咩卡通？
- ☐ 咩卡通而家啲細路都睇？
- ☐ 咩卡通而家個個細路都睇？
- ☐ 以上嘅句子都唔通順

Dou1 in wh-questions

- 而家啲細路都睇咩卡通？ is spoken by relatively younger Cantonese speakers.
- A **significant** effect of age is found ($\beta = -.036$, $SE = .016$, $z = -2.21$, $p = .03$).

而家啲細路都睇咩卡通？



Questions for future studies

- The syntactic account of why *dou1* cannot co-occur with a [+Q] wh-word in object position in (older speakers') Cantonese.
 - Is this allowed in Mandarin?
 - 他們都吃了甚麼？
 - Is the *dou1* really quantifying over the subject *di1 sai3lo6/tamen*? (Leftness Constraint)
- How does Mandarin influence cause younger speakers to accept this?
- Any other constructions that can show Mandarin influence on the use of *dou1*?

References

Hsu, Y. Y., & Lee, K. K. (2019). Similarities and differences of Dou in Mandarin and Cantonese. In *From Minimal Contrast to Meaning Construct: Corpus-based, Near Synonym Driven Approaches to Chinese Lexical Semantics* (pp. 77-89). Singapore: Springer Nature Singapore.

Yip, K. F. (2022). Universal concord as syntactic agreement. *U. Penn Working Papers in Linguistics* 28:221–232.